

India, US join hands for open source platform

The Indian government has joined hands with the US administration on Data.gov-in-a-Box, an open source version of the Obama administration's transparency platform. The open data platform, Data.gov-in-a-box, is available for implementation by countries globally, encouraging governments around the world to start up open data sites that promote transparency, improve citizen engagement and engage application developers in continuously improving these efforts. The US government has plans to launch a full-scale open source project early this year and the Indian government has extended its support for this endeavour.



NIC deploys open source software for e-governance projects

The National Informatics Centre (NIC) has chosen and deployed the open source Eucalyptus Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) software in the e-governance cloud project in India. With this, NIC aims to deliver the power of modern information technology to remote districts and villages throughout the country.

NIC is providing the network backbone and a wide range of ICT (information and communication technologies) services to government organisations throughout India, including a nationwide communication network for decentralised planning, improvement in government services, and wider transparency of national and local government institutions.



New kernels arrive for Ubuntu 10.04 LTS

Canonical has come up with two new kernels for Ubuntu 10.04 LTS. Kernels 2.6.32-35 and 2.6.38-12 are now being distributed via the Ubuntu repositories. Kernel 2.6.32 continues to be the default kernel; it was used when Ubuntu 10.04 LTS was first made available in April 2010. The update fixes a number of security vulnerabilities that could cause the kernel to crash, disable the system or allow data theft. Canonical has released an update for the back-port of kernel 2.6.38 from Ubuntu 11.04, first released in April 2011, to the standard repository. It includes a number of security updates, without which an attacker could get root privileges on a system.



A tablet exclusively for kids!

Toys"R"Us has launched the new Nabi tablet, exclusively for kids. The 'education-cum-fun' slate for kids runs Android and is powered by a 1.1 GHz dual-core Cortex A9 CPU that comes with an embedded PowerVR

Customise your Android with Androidify!

If you are bored with the regular green Android, well, change it! Now you can personalise your Android and make it look the way you want. Google has announced a new service called Androidify, which allows Android users to create personalised avatars of the Android mascot.



It is a free service and allows users to control the minutest details of the avatar. Users can now modify it by choosing a different body type, face size, hair type/colour, clothes, accessories, and even facial marks and scars from Androidify. The service is available for all devices running Android version 2.1 and above.

Free GPS navigation app for Android launched

Now, a free GPS navigation application for Android smartphones is available



in the Android Market. This useful app lets you browse maps by dragging and scrolling, and allows you to toggle between 2D, 3D and safety screen mode. You can access day and night maps with low-glare mode, for safer night driving. Already available for iPhone, the Navfree app gathers OpenStreetMap data to guide users around different localities. It is available on Android for Europe, North America, Australia, New Zealand, India, South Africa and Latin America.